

Minimum ℓ -degree Turán spectra and finite forbidden subfamilies

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Abstract

Let $k > \ell \geq 1$ be integers. For a family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -uniform hypergraphs (k -graphs), its ℓ -degree Turán density $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F})$ is the asymptotic maximum of the normalized minimum ℓ -degree over all $\mathcal{F}$ -free k -graphs. In this paper, we prove that for all integers $k > \ell > 2$ and every $\alpha \in [0, 1)$, there exists an infinite family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs such that $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \alpha$, while every finite subfamily $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}$ satisfies $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') > \alpha$. This proves the conjecture of Mubayi and Zhao on codegree Turán densities for every $k > 3$. As an immediate consequence, the set $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty$ of ℓ -degree Turán densities of arbitrary nonempty families of k -graphs is $[0, 1)$ whenever $k > \ell > 2$, answering the question of Lo and Markström in this range.

Keywords: minimum ℓ -degree, Turán spectrum, hypergraph Lagrangian, forbidden family.

1 Introduction

Extremal graph theory asks how dense a graph or hypergraph can be while avoiding prescribed subgraphs. For an integer $k \geq 2$, a k -uniform hypergraph, or simply a k -graph, is a pair $H = (V(H), E(H))$ with $E(H) \subseteq \binom{V(H)}{k}$. We write $v(H) = |V(H)|$ and $e(H) = |E(H)|$. All k -graphs considered in this paper are finite and simple. Given a nonempty family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs, each containing at least one edge, a k -graph is $\mathcal{F}$ -free if it contains no member of $\mathcal{F}$ as a subgraph. The classical Turán number is

$$\text{ex}(n, \mathcal{F}) = \max\{e(H) : v(H) = n, H \text{ is } \mathcal{F}\text{-free}\},$$

and the Turán density of $\mathcal{F}$ is

$$\pi(\mathcal{F}) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\text{ex}(n, \mathcal{F})}{\binom{n}{k}}.$$

The limit exists because the normalized Turán numbers form a non-increasing sequence. If $\mathcal{F} = \{F\}$, we write $\text{ex}(n, F)$ and $\pi(F)$.

The spectrum of possible Turán densities is itself a central object in extremal hypergraph theory. Let $\Pi^{(k)}$, $\Pi_{\text{fin}}^{(k)}$ and $\Pi_\infty^{(k)}$ denote the sets of densities of, respectively, single forbidden k -graphs, finite forbidden families and arbitrary nonempty forbidden families. Then

$$\Pi^{(k)} \subseteq \Pi_{\text{fin}}^{(k)} \subseteq \Pi_\infty^{(k)} \subseteq [0, 1).$$

For graphs, the Erdős–Stone–Simonovits theorem [3, 4] gives the complete picture:

$$\Pi^{(2)} = \Pi_{\text{fin}}^{(2)} = \Pi_\infty^{(2)} = \left\{ \frac{r-1}{r} : r \geq 1 \right\}. \quad (1.1)$$

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For $k \geq 3$, the situation is considerably more complicated. Determining $\pi(F)$ is difficult even for many small 3-graphs; see the surveys of Keevash [8] and Sidorenko [15]. The spectrum also exhibits phenomena with no analogue for graphs. Frankl and Rödl [5] showed that the spectrum is not well-ordered, and Pikhurko [14] proved, among other results, that the spectrum for arbitrary forbidden families is uncountable and is strictly larger than the spectrum for finite forbidden families.

A second phenomenon, which is especially relevant here, concerns the interaction among several forbidden k -graphs. A finite family $\mathcal{F}$ is called *principal* if

$$\pi(\mathcal{F}) = \min\{\pi(F) : F \in \mathcal{F}\};$$

otherwise it is *non-principal*. Every finite family of graphs is principal by (1.1). In contrast, Mubayi and Rödl [12] conjectured the existence of non-principal families of k -graphs. Balogh [1] constructed such a family of 3-graphs, and Mubayi and Pikhurko [11] subsequently found non-principal families of size two for every uniformity $k \geq 3$. These results show that, for hypergraphs, the extremal effect of a forbidden family need not be determined by any one of its members.

1.1 ℓ -degree Turán densities

A natural local refinement of the classical Turán problem replaces the total number of edges by a minimum ℓ -degree condition. Let $1 \leq \ell < k$, let H be a k -graph, and let $S \in \binom{V(H)}{\ell}$. The link of S is

$$N_H(S) = \left\{ T \in \binom{V(H) \setminus S}{k-\ell} : S \cup T \in E(H) \right\},$$

its degree is $d_H(S) = |N_H(S)|$, and the minimum ℓ -degree of H is

$$\delta_\ell(H) = \min_{S \in \binom{V(H)}{\ell}} d_H(S).$$

For a family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs, define

$$\text{ex}_\ell^{(k)}(n, \mathcal{F}) = \max\{\delta_\ell(H) : v(H) = n, H \text{ is } \mathcal{F}\text{-free}\}.$$

The corresponding ℓ -degree Turán density is

$$\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\text{ex}_\ell^{(k)}(n, \mathcal{F})}{\binom{n-\ell}{k-\ell}}. \quad (1.2)$$

The limit exists for arbitrary forbidden families: Mubayi and Zhao [13] proved this in the codegree case $\ell = k - 1$, and Lo and Markström [10] proved it for all $1 \leq \ell < k$. We use the convention $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\emptyset) = 1$. These densities interpolate between the classical Turán density and the codegree density; more precisely, for every forbidden family $\mathcal{F}$,

$$\gamma_{k-1}^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) \leq \gamma_{k-2}^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) \leq \dots \leq \gamma_1^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \pi(\mathcal{F}). \quad (1.3)$$

As in the classical setting, let $\Gamma_{k,\ell}$, $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^{\text{fin}}$ and $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty$ denote the sets of ℓ -degree Turán densities obtained from a single forbidden k -graph, a finite forbidden family and an arbitrary nonempty forbidden family, respectively. Thus

$$\Gamma_{k,\ell} \subseteq \Gamma_{k,\ell}^{\text{fin}} \subseteq \Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty \subseteq [0, 1]. \quad (1.4)$$

The first two sets in (1.4) are countable, whereas the third may contain uncountably many values. This elementary distinction is important: a theorem realizing every real number in an interval necessarily requires arbitrary, and in general infinite, forbidden families.

The case $\ell = 1$ is governed by the classical Turán spectrum, by (1.3). In particular, a theorem of Erdős [2] implies that no classical k -graph Turán density lies in $(0, k!/k^k)$. Thus $\Gamma_{k,1}^\infty$ has a nontrivial gap immediately to the right of zero. The situation for minimum ℓ -degree when $\ell > 1$ is strikingly different. Mubayi and Zhao [13, Theorem 1.6] proved that $\Gamma_{k,k-1}^\infty$ is dense in $[0, 1)$ for every $k \geq 3$. They conjectured a much stronger statement: for each prescribed value one should be able to choose an infinite forbidden family for which no finite subfamily already has the same density. In their notation, Conjecture 1.7 asserts that, for every $k \geq 3$ and every $\alpha \in [0, 1)$, there exists an infinite family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs such that

$$\gamma_{k-1}^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \alpha < \gamma_{k-1}^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') \quad \text{for every finite } \mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}. \quad (1.5)$$

This strengthens non-principality: no finite subfamily, rather than merely no single member, determines the density.

Lo and Markström [10, Theorem 1.7] extended the density result of Mubayi and Zhao by proving that $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty$ is dense in $[0, 1)$ for every $k > \ell > 1$. They then asked whether the spectrum is in fact the whole interval $[0, 1)$. Their question and the conjecture of Mubayi and Zhao are related but distinct: the former asks for exact realization of every real value, while the latter additionally asks for the strict inequality required for every finite subfamily in (1.5).

There has recently been substantial progress for finite forbidden families. Gao, Pikhurko, Rong and Sun [6] proved that every rational number in $[0, 1)$ is the codegree Turán density of a finite family of k -graphs. Tang and Zhou [16] extended this rational-value result to every pair $k > \ell > k/2$. They also constructed, for all $k > \ell \geq 1$, single forbidden k -graphs with ℓ -degree Turán density $1 - q^{\ell-k}$ for every integer $q \geq 2$, and established two-element non-principal families for all $k > \ell > 1$. These results describe a substantial part of the countable spectra $\Gamma_{k,\ell}$ and $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^{\text{fin}}$, but they cannot by themselves yield a full interval: there are only countably many finite forbidden families, and density of a spectrum does not imply that every value is attained.

1.2 Main result

Our main theorem determines the spectrum for arbitrary forbidden families throughout the range $k > \ell \geq 3$. More strongly, the forbidden family can be chosen so that each finite subfamily has strictly larger density. It can also be chosen to be an antichain. Recall that a family of k -graphs is an *antichain* under the subgraph relation if no two distinct members are comparable under subgraph containment.

Theorem 1.1. *Let $k > \ell \geq 3$ and $\alpha \in [0, 1)$. There exists an infinite antichain $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs such that no member has an isolated vertex and*

$$\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \alpha < \gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') \quad \text{for every finite } \mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}. \quad (1.6)$$

For $\ell = k - 1$, Theorem 1.1 proves (1.5) for every $k \geq 4$. The antichain condition ensures that no member of $\mathcal{F}$ contains another member as a subgraph, while the condition on isolated vertices rules out enlargements obtained only by adding isolated vertices. The strict inequality in (1.6) concerns finite subfamilies of the particular family $\mathcal{F}$; it does not rule out the possibility that some other finite forbidden family has density α .

The corresponding spectrum result is immediate.

Corollary 1.2. For all integers $k > \ell \geq 3$, one has $\Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty = [0, 1)$.

Proof. [Theorem 1.1](#) gives $[0, 1) \subseteq \Gamma_{k,\ell}^\infty$. The reverse inclusion holds for every nonempty forbidden family, as shown in [Section 2.1](#). $\square$

Thus [Corollary 1.2](#) answers the question of Lo and Markström for every $k > \ell \geq 3$. Compared with the results for finite forbidden families in [\[6, 16\]](#), the present theorem has a different scope. It replaces rational values by all real values, removes the condition $\ell > k/2$, and strengthens two-element non-principality to the requirement that every finite subfamily has strictly larger density. The forbidden family constructed here is allowed to be infinite. The case $\ell = 2$ remains outside the present method; in particular, the codegree case $k = 3$ of the conjecture of Mubayi and Zhao is not settled here.

Proof strategy. The proof uses a cyclic multipartite construction controlled by the Lagrangian of an auxiliary ℓ -graph. Put $s = k - \ell$. Fix integers $m \geq k$ and $s \leq t \leq m - \ell$, and partition the vertex set into m cyclically ordered parts. We include every k -set meeting each part in at most $\ell - 1$ vertices. The remaining edges used in the construction have ℓ vertices in one part and one vertex in each of s distinct parts among the next t parts. For each choice of the latter s vertices, the part containing the ℓ vertices is colored by the vertices of an auxiliary ℓ -graph G ; the corresponding k -set is present precisely when the ℓ colors form an edge of G .

Let $\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ be the monotone family consisting of all subgraphs of k -graphs obtained in this way. We prove the exact formula

$$d_\ell(\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)) = c_{m,t} \lambda(G), \quad c_{m,t} = \frac{\binom{t}{s}}{m^s}, \quad (1.7)$$

where $\lambda(G)$ is the normalized Lagrangian of G . A balanced partition and independent random colorings give the lower bound. For the upper bound, a cyclic averaging argument selects a sufficiently large part for which the number of possible complementary s -sets is small. Averaging over the ℓ -sets in this part then allows us to apply the Lagrangian bound for G . The error term in this upper bound depends only on k, m, t , and not on the order or size of G . This uniform estimate allows G to range over an arbitrary family of auxiliary ℓ -graphs.

Pikhurko's theorem identifying the closure of the Lagrangian spectrum [\[14\]](#), together with the interval ending at 1 obtained by Liu and Pikhurko [\[9\]](#), provides auxiliary ℓ -graphs whose Lagrangians approach any prescribed value in a fixed interval below 1. Since the factors $c_{m,t}$ are dense in $(0, 1)$, [\(1.7\)](#) yields every positive density.

To ensure the strict inequality for finite subfamilies, we keep m, t fixed and intersect a decreasing sequence of monotone families obtained by imposing successively smaller upper bounds on the auxiliary Lagrangian. The densities of these families decrease to the prescribed value, while every finite subfamily of the resulting forbidden family is already contained in the forbidden family at an earlier stage, where the density is still larger. The value 0 is treated separately by cyclic multipartite constructions whose densities tend to zero. A common refinement of finitely many of the underlying partitions shows that every finite intersection of the corresponding monotone families still has positive ℓ -degree density. Finally, we pass to the minimal forbidden k -graphs for the resulting monotone family. They form the antichain in [Theorem 1.1](#) and have no isolated vertices.

Organization. In [Section 2](#) we collect the terminology for monotone families and minimal forbidden k -graphs, together with the Lagrangian results used later. The cyclic multipartite construction and its matching upper and lower bounds are developed in [Section 3](#). In [Section 4](#) we apply the

construction first to positive densities and then to zero density. The final section discusses the range of the theorem and the remaining cases.

2 Preliminaries

For a finite set X , let $\binom{X}{r}$ denote the family of its r -element subsets. For a positive integer n , let $[n] = \{1, \dots, n\}$. For integers $a \geq b \geq 0$, write $(a)_b = a(a-1) \cdots (a-b+1)$, with $(a)_0 = 1$. The complete r -graph on a vertices is denoted by $K_a^{(r)}$. All asymptotic statements concern the order of the host k -graph tending to infinity. Subscripts on $O(\cdot)$ specify the parameters on which the implicit constant may depend. All auxiliary r -graphs have nonempty vertex sets, and edgeless auxiliary r -graphs are allowed.

2.1 Monotone families and minimal forbidden k -graphs

Throughout the paper, a family of k -graphs is understood to be closed under isomorphism. A family $\mathcal{P}$ is *monotone* if every subgraph of a member of $\mathcal{P}$ also belongs to $\mathcal{P}$. For a family $\mathcal{F}$ of k -graphs, let $\text{Forb}(\mathcal{F})$ denote the monotone family of all $\mathcal{F}$ -free k -graphs.

Conversely, for a monotone family $\mathcal{P}$, define its associated forbidden family by

$$\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P}) = \{F : F \text{ is a finite } k\text{-graph and } F \notin \mathcal{P}\},$$

where one representative of each isomorphism type is retained. Then

$$\text{Forb}(\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})) = \mathcal{P}. \tag{2.1}$$

Indeed, every subgraph of a member of $\mathcal{P}$ again lies in $\mathcal{P}$, whereas a k -graph outside $\mathcal{P}$ is itself a member of $\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})$. All monotone families considered below contain the edgeless k -graph of every order. For such a family, define its ℓ -degree density by

$$d_\ell(\mathcal{P}) = \gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\max\{\delta_\ell(H) : H \in \mathcal{P}, v(H) = n\}}{\binom{n-\ell}{k-\ell}}. \tag{2.2}$$

The uniformity k will always be clear from the context. If $\mathcal{P} \subseteq \mathcal{Q}$, then $d_\ell(\mathcal{P}) \leq d_\ell(\mathcal{Q})$. Arbitrary unions and intersections of monotone families are again monotone.

For a monotone family $\mathcal{P}$, let

$$\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P}) = \{F \notin \mathcal{P} : \text{every proper subgraph of } F \text{ belongs to } \mathcal{P}\},$$

again retaining one representative of each isomorphism type. The members of $\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})$ are the *minimal forbidden k -graphs* for $\mathcal{P}$. The following elementary observation will be used at the end of the proof.

Lemma 2.1. *Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a monotone family that is closed under adding isolated vertices, and put $\alpha = d_\ell(\mathcal{P})$. Suppose that $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') > \alpha$ for every finite $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})$. Then $\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})$ is an infinite antichain of k -graphs with no isolated vertices, $\text{Forb}(\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})) = \mathcal{P}$, and*

$$\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})) = \alpha < \gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') \quad \text{for every finite } \mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P}).$$

1 *Proof.* Every finite k -graph outside $\mathcal{P}$ contains a subgraph that is minimal outside $\mathcal{P}$, and hence
2 $\text{Forb}(\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})) = \mathcal{P}$. Minimality also implies that $\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})$ is an antichain. If $F \in \mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})$ had an
3 isolated vertex v , then $F - v \in \mathcal{P}$, and closure under adding isolated vertices would give $F \in \mathcal{P}$, a
4 contradiction. The density statement and the strict inequality for finite subfamilies follow from the
5 hypothesis and the inclusion $\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P}) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})$. Finally, $\mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{P})$ cannot be finite, since otherwise it
6 could itself be used as $\mathcal{F}'$ in the strict inequality. $\square$

7 We also justify the exclusion of 1 from (1.4). Choose $F \in \mathcal{F}$ and put $f = v(F)$. An $\mathcal{F}$ -free k -graph
8 H is $K_f^{(k)}$ -free, so every f -set of vertices contains a non-edge. Double counting pairs consisting of a
9 non-edge and an f -set containing it gives

$$\frac{e(H)}{\binom{n}{k}} \leq 1 - \binom{f}{k}^{-1} \quad (n \geq f).$$

10 On the other hand,

$$\frac{\delta_\ell(H)}{\binom{n-\ell}{k-\ell}} \leq \frac{\sum_{S \in \binom{V(H)}{\ell}} d_H(S)}{\binom{n}{\ell} \binom{n-\ell}{k-\ell}} = \frac{e(H)}{\binom{n}{k}}. \quad (2.3)$$

11 Consequently $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) < 1$ for every nonempty forbidden family under consideration.

12 2.2 Hypergraph Lagrangians and Turán densities

13 For a finite r -graph G , let

$$\Delta_G = \left\{ (x_v)_{v \in V(G)} : x_v \geq 0, \sum_{v \in V(G)} x_v = 1 \right\}.$$

14 Its normalized *Lagrangian* is

$$\lambda(G) = \max_{\mathbf{x} \in \Delta_G} r! \sum_{e \in E(G)} \prod_{v \in e} x_v. \quad (2.4)$$

15 The maximum exists by compactness. If r colors are sampled independently according to $\mathbf{x}$, then
16 $r! \sum_{e \in E(G)} \prod_{v \in e} x_v$ is the probability that the sampled colors are distinct and form an edge of G . In
17 particular, $0 \leq \lambda(G) \leq 1$.

18 Suppose a set of size a is colored by $V(G)$, and a_v elements receive color v . The number of r -sets
19 whose colors form an edge of G is

$$\sum_{e \in E(G)} \prod_{v \in e} a_v \leq \frac{\lambda(G)}{r!} a^r. \quad (2.5)$$

20 The upper bound depends on G only through $\lambda(G)$. We also record that

$$\frac{\binom{a}{r}}{a^r} \leq \lambda(K_a^{(r)}) \leq 1 \quad \text{and hence} \quad \lambda(K_a^{(r)}) \rightarrow 1 \quad \text{as } a \rightarrow \infty. \quad (2.6)$$

21 The lower bound follows by assigning weight $1/a$ to every vertex.

22 Let $\Lambda^{(r)}$ be the set of Lagrangians of finite r -graphs, and let $\Pi_\infty^{(r)}$ denote the set of Turán densities
23 of arbitrary families of r -graphs. Here we allow the empty forbidden family, so $1 \in \Pi_\infty^{(r)}$. The
24 following two results on classical Turán densities are used in the proof for positive densities.

25 **Theorem 2.2** (Pikhurko [14]). *For every integer $r \geq 3$, the closure of $\Lambda^{(r)}$ is $\Pi_\infty^{(r)}$.*

Theorem 2.3 (Liu–Pikhurko [9]). *For every integer $r \geq 3$, there is a constant $\delta_r > 0$ such that $[1 - \delta_r, 1] \subseteq \Pi_\infty^{(r)}$.*

We shall use these two theorems through the following immediate consequence, which gives approximation from below.

Lemma 2.4. *For every integer $r \geq 3$, there exists $b_r \in (0, 1)$ such that every $\tau \in (b_r, 1)$ is the supremum of the Lagrangians of finite r -graphs whose Lagrangian is strictly smaller than τ .*

Proof. Choose $b_r \in (0, 1)$ so that $[b_r, 1] \subseteq \Pi_\infty^{(r)}$, using Theorem 2.3. Fix $\tau \in (b_r, 1)$ and $\varepsilon > 0$. Choose

$$\max\{b_r, \tau - \varepsilon\} < \beta < \tau,$$

and then choose $\eta > 0$ so small that $(\beta - \eta, \beta + \eta) \subseteq (\tau - \varepsilon, \tau)$. Since $\beta \in \Pi_\infty^{(r)}$, Theorem 2.2 gives a finite r -graph G with $|\lambda(G) - \beta| < \eta$. Thus $\tau - \varepsilon < \lambda(G) < \tau$, as required. $\square$

Concentration. We use Hoeffding’s inequality [7] in the following form. If $X_1, \dots, X_N$ are independent random variables with values in $[0, 1]$, then, for every $u > 0$,

$$\mathbb{P} \left(\sum_{j=1}^N X_j < \mathbb{E} \sum_{j=1}^N X_j - u \right) \leq \exp \left(-\frac{2u^2}{N} \right). \quad (2.7)$$

Only sums of indicator variables occur below. Independence is needed for the extensions of a fixed ℓ -set; the degree variables of different ℓ -sets need not be independent.

3 A cyclic multipartite construction

Throughout this section, fix integers $k > \ell \geq 3$ and put $s = k - \ell$. Let m, t be integers satisfying $m \geq k$ and $s \leq t \leq m - \ell$, and set $c_{m,t} := (t)_s / m^s = s! \binom{t}{s} / m^s$. The parameters k, ℓ, m, t remain fixed throughout the construction, whereas the auxiliary ℓ -graph may vary. We define a monotone family of k -graphs and determine its minimum ℓ -degree Turán density by matching upper and lower bounds. The constants in these bounds are independent of the auxiliary ℓ -graph, a fact that will later allow us to use a family of auxiliary ℓ -graphs.

3.1 The construction

We first define the k -graphs that underlie the construction and then pass to the monotone family formed by all of their subgraphs.

Definition 3.1 (Cyclic multipartite G -construction). Let G be a finite ℓ -graph, let V be a finite set, and let $\mathcal{V} = (V_0, \dots, V_{m-1})$ be an ordered partition of V into m parts, where empty parts are allowed. We regard all part indices as elements of $\mathbb{Z}_m$. For each $i \in \mathbb{Z}_m$, put $I_i = \{i + 1, \dots, i + t\}$ and define

$$\mathcal{T}_i = \mathcal{T}_i(\mathcal{V}) := \left\{ T \in \binom{V}{s} : T \subseteq \bigcup_{j \in I_i} V_j \text{ and } |T \cap V_j| \leq 1 \text{ for every } j \in I_i \right\}. \quad (3.1)$$

Thus, every member of $\mathcal{T}_i$ is obtained by choosing one vertex from each of s distinct parts among $V_{i+1}, \dots, V_{i+t}$.

For every $i \in \mathbb{Z}_m$ and $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$, choose a map $\phi_{i,T} : V_i \rightarrow V(G)$, and write $\Phi = (\phi_{i,T})_{i \in \mathbb{Z}_m, T \in \mathcal{T}_i}$. The maps with different indices are chosen separately; in particular, no compatibility is imposed when two indexing sets T intersect.

The k -graph $H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$ has vertex set V . A set $X \in \binom{V}{k}$ is an edge of $H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$ if and only if one of the following holds.

(i) $|X \cap V_i| \leq \ell - 1$ for every $i \in \mathbb{Z}_m$;

(ii) for some $i \in \mathbb{Z}_m$, there are $S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell}$ and $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$ such that $X = S \dot{\cup} T$ and $\{\phi_{i,T}(u) : u \in S\} \in E(G)$.

The two edge types in Definition 3.1 are disjoint. An edge of type (ii) contains exactly ℓ vertices in one part and at most one vertex in every other part, so the index i in its definition is unique. Moreover, the colors $\phi_{i,T}(u)$, $u \in S$, are pairwise distinct whenever the set in type (ii) is an edge of G .

Let $\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ be the family of all k -graphs H for which there are an ordered m -partition $\mathcal{V}$ of $V(H)$ and maps Φ as in Definition 3.1 satisfying

$$E(H) \subseteq E(H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)). \quad (3.2)$$

Equivalently, $\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ consists of all subgraphs of the k -graphs arising from the construction above. It is a monotone family: deleting vertices amounts to restricting the parts and the relevant maps, while deleting edges leaves the same witnessing data. It is also closed under adding isolated vertices. Indeed, a new vertex may be placed in any part, after which the existing maps are extended and the maps corresponding to newly created indexing sets are chosen arbitrarily.

Every part V_i is independent in $H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$. It follows that, regardless of G , every member of $\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ is $K_{m(k-1)+1}^{(k)}$ -free: among any $m(k-1)+1$ vertices, one part contains at least k vertices, and these vertices do not span an edge.

If $t = s$ and all k -sets of type (ii) are included, the balanced construction reduces to the cyclic multipartite construction of Lo and Markström [10]. Here the auxiliary ℓ -graph G controls the contribution of the edges of type (ii) through its Lagrangian. Assigning a separate map $\phi_{i,T}$ to each T is important both for the averaging argument in the upper bound and for the independent random choices used in the lower bound.

3.2 The uniform upper bound

We first record a cyclic estimate for the number of members of $\mathcal{T}_i$. For nonnegative reals $z_1, \dots, z_t$, let

$$e_s(z_1, \dots, z_t) = \sum_{A \in \binom{[t]}{s}} \prod_{j \in A} z_j.$$

The number of sets in $\mathcal{T}_i$ is $e_s(|V_{i+1}|, \dots, |V_{i+t}|)$. The following lemma selects a nonempty part for which this quantity is small.

Lemma 3.2. *Let $1 \leq s \leq t < m$, and let $y_0, \dots, y_{m-1} \geq 0$ with $N = \sum_i y_i > 0$. There is an index i with $y_i > 0$ such that*

$$e_s(y_{i+1}, \dots, y_{i+t}) \leq \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{N}{m}\right)^s. \quad (3.3)$$

Proof. Set $W_j = \sum_{h=1}^t y_{j+h}$. Since $\sum_j W_j = tN$, some j satisfies $W_j \leq tN/m$. If $y_j > 0$, choose $i = j$. Otherwise let i be the last positive-weight index preceding j in the cyclic order, and let d be

1 the forward distance from i to j . Then $y_{i+1} = \dots = y_{i+d} = 0$. If $d \geq t$, we have $W_i = 0$. If $d < t$,
2 every possibly nonzero term in W_i also occurs in W_j . In either case,

$$y_i > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad W_i \leq tN/m. \quad (3.4)$$

3 For nonnegative $z_1, \dots, z_t$, Maclaurin's inequality gives

$$e_s(z_1, \dots, z_t) \leq \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{z_1 + \dots + z_t}{t} \right)^s. \quad (3.5)$$

4 Applying this inequality together with (3.4) yields (3.3). $\square$

5 We apply the lemma after ignoring parts of order less than $\sqrt{n}$.

6 **Proposition 3.3.** There are constants $C = C(k, \ell, m, t)$ and $n_0 = n_0(k, \ell, m, t)$ such that, for every
7 finite ℓ -graph G , every $n \geq n_0$ and every $H \in \mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ with $v(H) = n$,

$$\frac{\delta_\ell(H)}{\binom{n-\ell}{s}} \leq c_{m,t} \lambda(G) + Cn^{-1/2}. \quad (3.6)$$

8 In particular, C and n_0 do not depend on G .

9 *Proof.* Since H is contained in some $H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$ and adding edges cannot decrease the minimum
10 ℓ -degree, it is enough to consider $H = H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$. Put $n_i = |V_i|$, and define

$$y_i = \begin{cases} n_i, & n_i \geq \sqrt{n}, \\ 0, & n_i < \sqrt{n}. \end{cases}$$

11 For sufficiently large n , at least one y_i is positive. The parts with $y_i = 0$ contain at most $m\sqrt{n}$
12 vertices in total. Apply Lemma 3.2 to $(y_i)_{i=0}^{m-1}$. It gives an index i with $n_i \geq \sqrt{n}$ and

$$e_s(y_{i+1}, \dots, y_{i+t}) \leq \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m} \right)^s.$$

13 Every set in $\mathcal{T}_i$ either uses only parts of size at least $\sqrt{n}$ or contains a vertex from a smaller part.
14 There are at most $m\sqrt{n} \binom{n}{s-1}$ sets of the latter kind. Hence

$$|\mathcal{T}_i| \leq \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m} \right)^s + O_{k,m}(n^{s-1/2}). \quad (3.7)$$

15 Write $a = n_i$. For $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$ and $c \in V(G)$, let $a_c(T) = |\phi_{i,T}^{-1}(c)|$. Since $\sum_c a_c(T) = a$, (2.5) gives

$$|\{S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell} : S \cup T \in E(H)\}| = \sum_{c \in E(G)} \prod_{c \in e} a_c(T) \leq \frac{\lambda(G)}{\ell!} a^\ell. \quad (3.8)$$

16 An ℓ -set contained in V_i has no extension to an edge of type (i). In an edge of type (ii) containing it,
17 V_i must be the part containing ℓ vertices, so its complementary s -set lies in $\mathcal{T}_i$. We may therefore
18 sum (3.8) over all $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$ and average over $S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell}$ to obtain

$$\delta_\ell(H) \leq \frac{1}{\binom{a}{\ell}} \sum_{S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell}} d_H(S) \leq \lambda(G) \frac{a^\ell}{(a)_\ell} |\mathcal{T}_i|. \quad (3.9)$$

1 As $a \geq \sqrt{n}$,

$$\frac{a^\ell}{(a)_\ell} = 1 + O_k(n^{-1/2}).$$

2 Together with (3.7) and $\lambda(G) \leq 1$, this yields

$$\delta_\ell(H) \leq \lambda(G) \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s + O_{k,m}(n^{s-1/2}).$$

3 Finally, $\binom{n-\ell}{s} = n^s/s! + O_k(n^{s-1})$, so division by this quantity proves (3.6). All implicit constants
4 depend only on the fixed parameters k, ℓ, m, t . $\square$

5 3.3 The matching lower bound

6 For the lower bound, we choose the maps randomly. For a fixed ℓ -set contained in one part, distinct
7 complementary s -sets use independent maps, which allows us to control all ℓ -degrees simultaneously.

8 **Proposition 3.4.** There are constants $C = C(k, \ell, m, t)$ and $n_0 = n_0(k, \ell, m, t)$ such that, for every
9 finite ℓ -graph G and every $n \geq n_0$, there is an n -vertex k -graph $H \in \mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$ satisfying

$$\frac{\delta_\ell(H)}{\binom{n-\ell}{s}} \geq c_{m,t} \lambda(G) - C \left(n^{-1} + n^{-s/2} \sqrt{\log n} \right). \quad (3.10)$$

10 *Proof.* Choose a partition with $|V_i| = n/m + O(1)$ for each i , and let $\mathbf{x} \in \Delta_G$ attain $\lambda(G)$.
11 Independently for all triples (i, T, u) with $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$ and $u \in V_i$, choose $\phi_{i,T}(u)$ according to $\mathbf{x}$.
12 Let $H = H(G; \mathcal{V}, \Phi)$.

13 First fix $S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell}$. For any $T \in \mathcal{T}_i$, the probability that the colors on S form an edge of G is
14 $\lambda(G)$. These events are independent for distinct T , even if those sets share vertices, because the
15 random choices are indexed by the set T . Thus

$$d_H(S) \sim \text{Bin}(B_i, \lambda(G)), \quad B_i = |\mathcal{T}_i| = \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s + O_{k,m}(n^{s-1}). \quad (3.11)$$

16 Set $u = \sqrt{\ell + 3} n^{s/2} \sqrt{\log n}$. Since $B_i \leq n^s$, (2.7) gives

$$\mathbb{P}(d_H(S) < \lambda(G) B_i - u) \leq n^{-2\ell-6}.$$

17 There are at most n^ℓ such sets S . A union bound therefore shows that, with probability tending to
18 one, all of them satisfy

$$d_H(S) \geq \lambda(G) \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s - O_{k,m}(n^{s-1} + n^{s/2} \sqrt{\log n}). \quad (3.12)$$

19 The probability estimate is independent of G .

20 Next let $S \in \binom{V}{\ell}$ meet exactly $h \geq 2$ parts. Then $h \leq \ell$ and $|S \cap V_i| \leq \ell - 1$ for every i . Choose
21 s distinct parts not met by S , and take one vertex from each to obtain T . Every such $S \cup T$ is an
22 edge of type (i). There are at least

$$\binom{m-h}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s - O_{k,m}(n^{s-1}) \geq \binom{m-\ell}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s - O_{k,m}(n^{s-1})$$

$$\geq \binom{t}{s} \left(\frac{n}{m}\right)^s - O_{k,m}(n^{s-1}) \quad (3.13)$$

such sets T . The last inequality uses $t \leq m - \ell$. Since $\lambda(G) \leq 1$, this deterministic bound is at least the required lower estimate.

Choose an outcome for which (3.12) holds simultaneously for every ℓ -set in a part. Combining it with (3.13) and dividing by $\binom{n-\ell}{s}$ proves (3.10). $\square$

The two propositions determine the ℓ -degree density of the monotone family $\mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$. Since the estimate in Proposition 3.3 is uniform in G , we may also allow the auxiliary ℓ -graph to range over an arbitrary family.

3.4 Auxiliary ℓ -graphs

We now allow the auxiliary ℓ -graph to range over a nonempty family. Throughout this subsection, $s = k - \ell$ and the integers m, t satisfy $m \geq k$ and $s \leq t \leq m - \ell$.

Proposition 3.5. Let $k > \ell \geq 3$, and let $\mathcal{G}$ be a nonempty family of finite ℓ -graphs. Set $\tau := \sup_{G \in \mathcal{G}} \lambda(G)$ and $\mathcal{P}(\mathcal{G}; m, t) := \bigcup_{G \in \mathcal{G}} \mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$. Then $d_\ell(\mathcal{P}(\mathcal{G}; m, t)) = c_{m,t}\tau$. In particular, the associated forbidden family is nonempty and has ℓ -degree Turán density $c_{m,t}\tau$.

Proof. The union $\mathcal{P} = \mathcal{P}(\mathcal{G}; m, t)$ is a monotone family and contains the edgeless k -graph of every order. It excludes $K_{m(k-1)+1}^{(k)}$, so $\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{P})$ is nonempty. For any n -vertex $H \in \mathcal{P}$, there is some $G \in \mathcal{G}$ with $H \in \mathcal{P}(G; m, t)$. By Proposition 3.3,

$$\frac{\delta_\ell(H)}{\binom{n-\ell}{s}} \leq c_{m,t}\lambda(G) + Cn^{-1/2} \leq c_{m,t}\tau + Cn^{-1/2}.$$

The same constant C and the same lower bound on n apply to every $G \in \mathcal{G}$. This proves $d_\ell(\mathcal{P}) \leq c_{m,t}\tau$ even though the choice of G may depend on H and on n .

For the reverse inequality, fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and choose $G \in \mathcal{G}$ with $\lambda(G) > \tau - \varepsilon$. By Proposition 3.4, for every sufficiently large n there is an $H \in \mathcal{P}(G; m, t) \subseteq \mathcal{P}$ with

$$\frac{\delta_\ell(H)}{\binom{n-\ell}{s}} \geq c_{m,t}(\tau - \varepsilon) - o(1).$$

Letting $n \rightarrow \infty$ and then $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$ proves the claimed equality. $\square$

The conclusion of Proposition 3.5 does not follow from the individual densities alone: in general, the density of an increasing union of monotone families need not equal the supremum of their densities. Here Proposition 3.3 gives, for every n , an upper bound that is uniform over all $G \in \mathcal{G}$, and this is the additional information needed for the union.

We next record that the coefficients $c_{m,t}$ are dense in $(0, 1)$.

Lemma 3.6. For fixed $k > \ell \geq 3$ and $s = k - \ell$, the set

$$\left\{ \frac{\binom{t}{s}}{m^s} : m \geq k, s \leq t \leq m - \ell \right\}$$

is dense in $(0, 1)$.

1 *Proof.* Fix $\beta \in (0, 1)$ and put $q = \beta^{1/s}$. For each sufficiently large m , let $t = \lfloor qm \rfloor$. Since $0 < q < 1$,
2 we have $s \leq t \leq m - \ell$ for all sufficiently large m . Moreover,

$$\frac{(t)_s}{m^s} = \prod_{j=0}^{s-1} \frac{\lfloor qm \rfloor - j}{m} \longrightarrow q^s = \beta.$$

3

□

4 Proof of the main theorem

5 Throughout this section, put $s = k - \ell$. We construct a monotone family $\mathcal{Q}$ with $d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) = \alpha$ such
6 that every finite subfamily of its associated forbidden family $\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q})$ has strictly larger ℓ -degree Turán
7 density. For positive α , the integers m, t remain fixed while the upper bound on the auxiliary
8 Lagrangian decreases to the required value. For $\alpha = 0$, we intersect a sequence of monotone families
9 arising from uncolored cyclic multipartite constructions. We then apply [Lemma 2.1](#) to obtain the
10 antichain in the statement of the theorem.

11 4.1 Positive densities

12 **Proposition 4.1.** Let $k > \ell \geq 3$ and $0 < \alpha < 1$. There exists a monotone family $\mathcal{Q}$, closed under
13 adding isolated vertices, such that $d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) = \alpha$ and $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') > \alpha$ for every finite $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q})$.

14 *Proof.* Let $b_\ell \in (0, 1)$ be given by [Lemma 2.4](#). Since $0 < \alpha < 1$, the interval $(\alpha, \min\{1, \alpha/b_\ell\})$ is
15 nonempty. By [Lemma 3.6](#), choose integers m, t satisfying $m \geq k$ and $s \leq t \leq m - \ell$ such that, with
16 $c = c_{m,t}$,

$$\alpha < c < \min\{1, \alpha/b_\ell\}. \quad (4.1)$$

17 Put $\tau = \alpha/c$. Then $b_\ell < \tau < 1$. For each $u \in (b_\ell, 1)$, define

$$\mathcal{Q}(u) = \bigcup_{\substack{G \text{ a finite } \ell\text{-graph} \\ \lambda(G) < u}} \mathcal{P}(G; m, t). \quad (4.2)$$

18 Each $\mathcal{Q}(u)$ is a monotone family and is closed under adding isolated vertices. By [Lemma 2.4](#)
19 and [Proposition 3.5](#),

$$d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}(u)) = cu. \quad (4.3)$$

20 Also, $u < v$ implies $\mathcal{Q}(u) \subseteq \mathcal{Q}(v)$.

21 Take

$$\tau_i = \tau + \frac{1 - \tau}{i + 1} \quad (i \geq 1), \quad \mathcal{Q} = \bigcap_{i \geq 1} \mathcal{Q}(\tau_i).$$

22 Then $\tau_i \downarrow \tau$, and

$$\mathcal{Q}(\tau) \subseteq \mathcal{Q} \subseteq \mathcal{Q}(\tau_i) \quad \text{for every } i.$$

23 Using (4.3) and monotonicity gives

$$\alpha = c\tau \leq d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) \leq \inf_{i \geq 1} c\tau_i = c\tau = \alpha.$$

24 Thus $d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) = \alpha$.

Let $\mathcal{F}_i = \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q}(\tau_i))$. Since the families $\mathcal{Q}(\tau_i)$ form a decreasing sequence, the forbidden families $\mathcal{F}_i$ form an increasing sequence. Furthermore,

$$\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q}) = \bigcup_{i \geq 1} \mathcal{F}_i. \quad (4.4)$$

Indeed, a finite k -graph is outside $\mathcal{Q}$ if and only if it is outside at least one $\mathcal{Q}(\tau_i)$.

Fix a nonempty finite family $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q})$. By (4.4) and the nesting, there is an i such that $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}_i$. Forbidding fewer k -graphs cannot lower the density, so

$$\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') \geq \gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}_i) = d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}(\tau_i)) = c\tau_i > c\tau = \alpha.$$

The assertion for the empty subfamily follows from the convention $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\emptyset) = 1$. Finally, since every family in (4.2) is closed under adding isolated vertices, their intersection $\mathcal{Q}$ has the same closure condition. $\square$

4.2 Zero density

For zero density, no auxiliary ℓ -graph is needed. We use the uncolored cyclic multipartite construction and show that finitely many such constructions can be realized simultaneously.

Fix $k > \ell \geq 3$, and again put $s = k - \ell$. For $m \geq k$ and a partition $\mathcal{V} = (V_0, \dots, V_{m-1})$, let $J_m(\mathcal{V})$ be the k -graph whose edges are

(i) all k -sets meeting each part in at most $\ell - 1$ vertices;

(ii) all $S \cup T$ with $S \in \binom{V_i}{\ell}$, $T \in \binom{V_s}{s}$, and $|T \cap V_{i+h}| = 1$ for each $h \in [s]$.

Here all part indices are modulo m . Let $\mathcal{R}_m$ be the monotone family consisting of all subgraphs of the k -graphs $J_m(\mathcal{V})$, where the part sizes are arbitrary. The balanced members of $\mathcal{R}_m$ are the cyclic constructions discussed in Section 3.

We have the following identity of monotone families:

$$\mathcal{R}_m = \bigcup_{a \geq \ell} \mathcal{P}(K_a^{(\ell)}; m, s). \quad (4.5)$$

One inclusion is immediate by ignoring the color restrictions. For the other, given a finite partition $\mathcal{V}$, choose $a \geq \max\{\ell, |V_0|, \dots, |V_{m-1}|\}$ and color every part injectively by $V(K_a^{(\ell)})$. Use that coloring for each map indexed by T . All edges of type (ii) are then present. By (2.6) and Proposition 3.5,

$$d_\ell(\mathcal{R}_m) = \frac{s!}{m^s}. \quad (4.6)$$

In particular, these positive densities tend to zero as $m \rightarrow \infty$. The next lemma shows that the intersection of any finitely many of these monotone families has positive ℓ -degree density.

Lemma 4.2. *Let $q \geq 1$ and $m_1, \dots, m_q \geq k$. Then*

$$d_\ell \left(\bigcap_{j=1}^q \mathcal{R}_{m_j} \right) \geq \prod_{j=1}^q \frac{s!}{m_j^s} > 0. \quad (4.7)$$

1 *Proof.* Put $M = \prod_{j=1}^q m_j$ and partition an n -element set V into the cells of a common refinement,

$$W_{\mathbf{a}}, \quad \mathbf{a} \in \prod_{j=1}^q \{0, \dots, m_j - 1\}, \quad |W_{\mathbf{a}}| = \frac{n}{M} + O(1).$$

2 For every $j \in [q]$, the j th coordinate of the cells defines an m_j -part partition $\mathcal{V}^{(j)}$ by

$$V_i^{(j)} = \bigcup_{\mathbf{a}: a_j = i} W_{\mathbf{a}} \quad (0 \leq i < m_j).$$

3 On the common vertex set V , form $J_j = J_{m_j}(\mathcal{V}^{(j)})$ and define H by

$$E(H) = \bigcap_{j=1}^q E(J_j).$$

4 Then $H \in \bigcap_{j=1}^q \mathcal{R}_{m_j}$.

5 Fix $S \in \binom{V}{\ell}$. For each j , let h_j be the number of parts of $\mathcal{V}^{(j)}$ met by S . We count ordered lists
6 $(v_1, \dots, v_s)$ of extension vertices, imposing the following requirements separately in each coordinate
7 j .

8 If $h_j = 1$, say $S \subseteq V_i^{(j)}$, require the s vertices to occupy the parts $V_{i+1}^{(j)}, \dots, V_{i+s}^{(j)}$, one in each.
9 There are $s!$ assignments of these part indices to the ordered vertices. If $h_j \geq 2$, require their part
10 indices to be distinct and to avoid all parts met by S . There are $(m_j - h_j)_s$ assignments. Write

$$A_j(S) = \begin{cases} s!, & h_j = 1, \\ (m_j - h_j)_s, & h_j \geq 2. \end{cases}$$

11 Since $h_j \leq \ell$ and $m_j \geq k = \ell + s$, in both cases $A_j(S) \geq s!$.

12 There are $\prod_j A_j(S)$ choices for the coordinate assignments of the ordered vertices. Each choice
13 specifies s distinct cells $W_{\mathbf{a}}$. These cells are disjoint from S : in every coordinate their indices avoid
14 the parts occupied by S . Thus each assignment yields

$$\left(\frac{n}{M}\right)^s + O_{k, m_1, \dots, m_q}(n^{s-1})$$

15 ordered lists of distinct vertices outside S . Every resulting set $S \cup \{v_1, \dots, v_s\}$ is an edge of J_j for
16 each j . It is of type (ii) when $h_j = 1$ and of type (i) when $h_j \geq 2$.

17 The requirements are invariant under permuting the extension vertices. Consequently each
18 unordered extension is counted exactly $s!$ times. It follows that

$$\begin{aligned} d_H(S) &\geq \frac{n^s}{s!} \prod_{j=1}^q \frac{A_j(S)}{m_j^s} - O_{k, m_1, \dots, m_q}(n^{s-1}) \\ &\geq \frac{n^s}{s!} \prod_{j=1}^q \frac{s!}{m_j^s} - O_{k, m_1, \dots, m_q}(n^{s-1}). \end{aligned} \tag{4.8}$$

19 The estimate is uniform in S . Dividing by $\binom{n-\ell}{s}$ and letting $n \rightarrow \infty$ proves (4.7). $\square$

20 The conclusion of [Lemma 4.2](#) uses the particular form of these cyclic multipartite families. Its
21 proof constructs a single k -graph belonging to all of them; the lower bound does not follow merely
22 from their individual densities.

23 We now intersect the families $\mathcal{R}_m$.

Proposition 4.3. For every $k > \ell \geq 3$, there exists a monotone family $\mathcal{Q}$, closed under adding isolated vertices, such that $d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) = 0$ and $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') > 0$ for every finite $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q})$.

Proof. Let

$$\mathcal{Q} = \bigcap_{m \geq k} \mathcal{R}_m.$$

This is a monotone family containing the edgeless k -graph of every order. By (4.6) and monotonicity,

$$0 \leq d_\ell(\mathcal{Q}) \leq \inf_{m \geq k} d_\ell(\mathcal{R}_m) = \inf_{m \geq k} \frac{s!}{m^s} = 0.$$

Fix a nonempty finite $\mathcal{F}' \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{Q})$. For each $F \in \mathcal{F}'$, choose $m(F) \geq k$ such that $F \notin \mathcal{R}_{m(F)}$. Set $M = \max_{F \in \mathcal{F}'} m(F)$. Every member of $\bigcap_{m=k}^M \mathcal{R}_m$ is $\mathcal{F}'$ -free: otherwise it would contain some $F \in \mathcal{F}'$ and, by monotonicity of $\mathcal{R}_{m(F)}$, would force $F \in \mathcal{R}_{m(F)}$. Applying Lemma 4.2 to the finite sequence $k, k+1, \dots, M$, we conclude that

$$\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}') \geq d_\ell \left(\bigcap_{m=k}^M \mathcal{R}_m \right) \geq \prod_{m=k}^M \frac{s!}{m^s} > 0.$$

Again, the empty subfamily has density 1. Closure under adding isolated vertices holds for each $\mathcal{R}_m$, by its definition or by (4.5), and hence also for $\mathcal{Q}$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. For $\alpha > 0$, choose the monotone family $\mathcal{Q}$ supplied by Proposition 4.1; for $\alpha = 0$, use Proposition 4.3. The hypotheses of Lemma 2.1 are satisfied in either case. Applying that lemma to $\mathcal{Q}$ produces an infinite antichain $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{F}_{\min}(\mathcal{Q})$ of k -graphs without isolated vertices such that $\gamma_\ell^{(k)}(\mathcal{F}) = \alpha$ and every finite subfamily has strictly larger minimum ℓ -degree Turán density. $\square$

5 Concluding remarks

Theorem 1.1 proves the conjecture of Mubayi and Zhao for every uniformity $k \geq 4$ and establishes the analogous conclusion for all $k > \ell \geq 3$. The spectrum equality in Corollary 1.2 answers the question of Lo and Markström in the same degree range. Thus every prescribed density has a realization for which no finite subfamily already determines the density. The forbidden family may be chosen as an antichain, and none of its members has an isolated vertex.

The assumption $\ell \geq 3$ enters only through the results on classical Turán densities applied to the auxiliary ℓ -graphs. The degree estimates for the multipartite construction follow from counting extensions of ℓ -sets and choosing independent colorings. The fact that the upper bound is uniform in the auxiliary ℓ -graph allows us to use arbitrary families of auxiliary ℓ -graphs without first classifying the extremal k -graphs. For positive densities, nested Lagrangian bounds give the strict inequality for every finite subfamily. At zero, a common refinement of finitely many cyclic partitions produces a k -graph of positive normalized minimum ℓ -degree.

The theorem concerns finite subfamilies of the particular infinite family produced by the proof. It does not give finite forbidden families with prescribed irrational density. The range $\ell = 2$ in the question of Lo and Markström, including the codegree case $k = 3$ in the conjecture of Mubayi and Zhao, requires ideas beyond the construction used here.

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